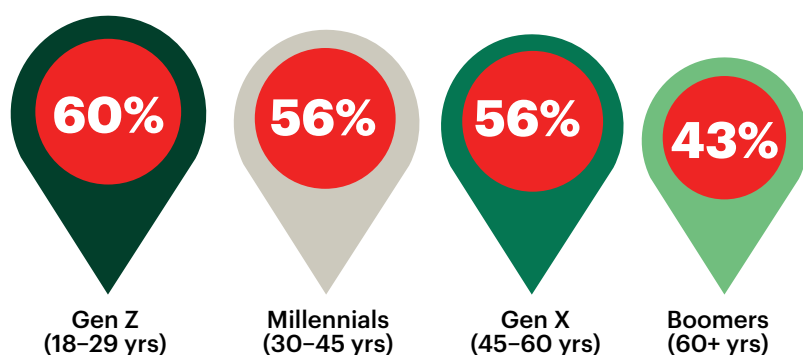


BUYING ON THE NET

Gen Z Is More Engaged with E-Commerce and Paid Delivery Services

Do you subscribe to any paid delivery service (e.g. Flipkart Plus, Amazon Prime, Zomato Gold, Swiggy One, etc.)?

Respondents who said Yes (%)



SAMPLE 8,200 (18-70 YEARS) ACROSS 25 MAJOR CITIES
SOURCE PRICE'S ICE 360 SURVEY (2024)

next decade, are poised to become the largest chunk of the labour force and the focus of most companies.

For a country like India that is still young, Gen Z will soon be the economic force to reckon with. A recent report by not-for-profit think

tank People Research on India's Consumer Economy (PRICE) estimates that as of 2025, nearly one in five young individuals globally lives in India. "This is a formidable 420-million strong force, constituting approximately 29% of the na-

tion's total population, and made up of individuals aged between 15 and 29 as defined by India's National Youth Policy (2014)," it said.

Labour sociologist Ellina Samantroy, Fellow at the V.V. Giri National Labour Institute, says India's expanding Gen Z or youth workforce offers a significant opportunity for the country to reap the demographic dividend. As per the recent Periodic Labour Force Survey 2023-24, around 46.5% of the labour force is in the 15-29 age group. "There has been an increase in labour force participation in this age group from 42% during 2021-22. One can see the economic growth potential of this cohort," she says.

However, with transitions and emerging opportunities in the world of work, it is important to harness the potential of this population cohort with adequate access to education and skilling, she says. Devangshu Dutta, founder and chief executive of Third Eyesight, a boutique management consulting firm focused on the retail and consumer products ecosystem, says Indian Gen Z consumers are not a uniform cohort.

"A critical issue in India is the coexistence of aspiration and constraint, and India's Gen Z are shaped by a mix of high digital exposure and wide economic disparity. While they are ambitious and globally aware, their purchasing power varies sharply across segments and locations," he says.

Further, urban, higher-income Gen Z display global consumption behaviours such as brand experimentation, social commerce and premium aspiration, whereas a large proportion of Gen Z in Tier II, Tier III and rural India is highly value-driven and necessity-led, while drawing their inspiration from global and national sources. He also points out that unlike Millennials, Indian Gen Z are also entering the